

Parliamentary Simulations

Committee Meeting

 Student Package



PARLIAMENT | PARLEMENT
CANADA

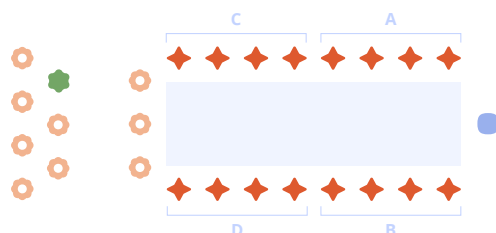
Instructions and content



Teacher instructions

The student package has several components. Character profiles can be cut out and given to each student. The rest of the student package is divided into role groups. Each role group contains a role overview, rules and decorum, and simulation preparation worksheets. Print the correct number of copies for each role group and distribute them to students.

The committee chair's content also includes a script they should use to help guide committee proceedings during the simulation.



Visual of role groups

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Character profiles



● Senator

Chair of the Standing Committee on Food and Nutrition, Senate Affiliation A, British Columbia

You were recently elected Chair of the Standing Committee on Food and Nutrition. Although most of your affiliation group supports the bill, you are undecided. You will do what you think is best, based on the arguments you hear during the committee meeting.

◆ Senator

Senate Affiliation A, Alberta

** Amendment*

You and your children don't like vegetables. You support this bill in principle but want to add a couple of other items to the list of restricted vegetables — asparagus and beets. You will introduce an amendment to add them to the list.

◆ Senator

Senate Affiliation A, Ontario

You think parents should be able to feed their children what they want to feed them. However, this bill is popular in your region. Additionally, you want to maintain good relationships in your Senate affiliation group, and many members support this bill. You are uncertain whether to support the bill or not.

◆ Senator

Senate Affiliation A, Quebec

You think parents should let children choose what foods they eat. You think most children will choose to eat vegetables that aren't on the list. You support this bill.

Character profiles



◆ Senator

Senate Affiliation A, Yukon

You are very interested in any bill that gives kids more agency over their own lives. You think this bill will empower them and are strongly in favour of it.

◆ Senator

Senate Affiliation B, Quebec

** Amendment*

You are concerned about the principle of the bill and think it should cover more than just vegetables. You believe dessert is a very important part of a happy life and plan to introduce an amendment that would require parents to serve dessert every night. If that amendment is accepted, you might support the bill.

◆ Senator

Senate Affiliation B, Northwest Territories

It can be very expensive to transport fresh fruit and vegetables to northern Canada. You think that the government should take action to make nutritious foods more affordable for families in your territory. You do not think this bill will do anything to lower the cost of nutritious foods.

◆ Senator

Senate Affiliation B, Newfoundland and Labrador

This bill is popular with many people in your province, but you don't agree with it. You think parents should expose children to many flavours, and that will train them to like more types of foods as they get older. You oppose the bill.

Character profiles



✦ Senator

Senate Affiliation B, Nova Scotia

You are worried that children in your province do not eat enough healthy foods. You believe that prohibiting the vegetables listed in this bill would make it even harder for parents to provide nutritious meals to their children. You oppose this bill.

✦ Senator

Senate Affiliation B, Saskatchewan

As a former chef, you think Canadians should be exposed to a wide variety of flavours and textures, including vegetables. You worry that introducing this bill will make dishes all across the country less nutritious and exciting to eat.

✦ Senator

Senate Affiliation C, New Brunswick

** Amendment*

You think this bill has merit, but you are worried about how the offences set out in section 7 could impact parents who are unable to pay the penalties if they forget and feed their children prohibited vegetables by accident. You plan to present an amendment to reduce the first-time offence to \$1,000, and subsequent offences to \$10,000.

✦ Senator

Senate Affiliation C, Ontario

You used to be a teacher, and you think that parents shouldn't make their kids eat foods that they don't like. You believe most kids will grow up to like vegetables, even if they don't eat them as children. However, you live in a province that has a lot of vegetable farms, and those farmers strongly oppose the bill. You are uncertain whether to support the bill or not.

Character profiles



◆ Senator

Senate Affiliation C, Nunavut

Before becoming a senator, you were a practicing medical doctor, and you want to help pass laws that will make Canadians healthier. Even though many members of your Senate affiliation are considering supporting the bill, you believe it will be bad for the health of Canadian kids. You oppose the bill.

◆ Senator

Senate Affiliation C, British Columbia

This bill is unpopular in your province because you have many vegetable farms, and many residents eat a lot of vegetables. Personally, you don't like most vegetables, and your parents didn't make you eat them when you were young. You are uncertain whether to support the bill or not.

◆ Senator

Senate Affiliation C, Manitoba

Some people in your province support this bill, and others think it's a terrible idea. You personally think it will make parents feel relieved that they don't have to serve certain vegetables to their kids. You are uncertain whether to support the bill or not.

◆ Senator

Senate Affiliation D, Nova Scotia

** Amendment*

You are a former restaurant owner. You oppose this bill as it is written right now, because it could be a real problem for restaurants in the country. You agree with the position of the witnesses from the Canadian Restaurant Association. You will introduce an amendment stipulating that the bill does not apply to restaurants. If that amendment is accepted, you might support the bill.

Character profiles



✦ Senator

Senate Affiliation D, Ontario

This bill is very unpopular where you live — a place that has many vegetable farmers. You don't like many vegetables yourself and now wish that your parents had you eat more of them as a child. You are opposed to the bill.

✦ Senator

Senate Affiliation D, Alberta

You were once an athlete, famous all over Canada for winning two gold medals in speed skating at the Olympics. You grew up eating a very healthy diet with lots of vegetables and protein and very little junk food. Your family is pescatarian, meaning you eat fish and seafood, but not meat or poultry. You oppose this bill as unhealthy for kids.

✦ Senator

Senate Affiliation D, Prince Edward Island

This bill is unpopular in your region. You do not understand why the government should try to tell parents what vegetables to feed their children. Parents should have the right to make these choices. You oppose the bill.

✦ Senator

Senate Affiliation D, Quebec

You know that many of your colleagues have concerns about this bill, but you think the bill has merit. Although you understand concerns that the government should not be telling parents what they can and cannot feed their kids, you think that giving children more opportunity to make decisions for themselves is good for their development and sense of self. You will listen closely to the committee meeting and base your decision on the discussions had there.

Character profiles



Minister of Food, Cabinet Minister

Last year, the prime minister selected you as the Minister of Food. This bill was your idea. You love food and sharing meals with your family, and you think this bill will help families enjoy food together more often because they won't be arguing about what to eat.

Mr./Ms./Mx.

President, Canadian Vegetable Growers Association

You are the head of an association representing thousands of vegetable farmers across Canada. Many of your members' livelihoods will be at risk if this bill is passed, impacting the entire Canadian economy. You strongly oppose the bill.

Mr./Ms./Mx.

Canadian Vegetable Growers Association

You own a small organic vegetable farm. You are a prominent advocate for the "eat local" movement, taking the position that everyone would be healthier if they ate food that was grown locally and preferably organically. Personally, you did not like vegetables when you were young but have now been a vegetarian for 20 years, and you believe that all children will learn to enjoy vegetables as they eat more of them.

Mr./Ms./Mx.

Canadian Vegetable Growers Association

You are a fourth-generation farmer. Your family has grown many types of vegetables over the decades, but today, Brussels sprouts are your biggest crop. You are uniquely worried about this bill because of how it would impact your livelihood. You are also concerned about its effect on other farmers across the country.

Character profiles



⚙️ **Mr./Ms./Mx.** _____

President, Council for the Rights of Families

You are the head of a national organization that advocates for the rights of families to make their own decisions about how children are raised. You do not think the government should be allowed to have a say in what food Canadian parents serve their children. You strongly oppose the bill.

⚙️ **Mr./Ms./Mx.** _____

Council for the Rights of Families

You are 16 years old and a youth representative on the Council for the Rights of Families. You maintain a social media presence with hundreds of thousands of followers, where you document your activism focused on the rights of children. Although you don't personally like the vegetables on the list, you believe parents and children should make their own decisions about their upbringing.

⚙️ **Mr./Ms./Mx.** _____

Council for the Rights of Families

You are a parent with three young children, and you joined the CRF because you felt that Parliament should hear the voices of families when considering new bills. You think that giving children the opportunity to make decisions for themselves is important for their confidence. You also worry that prohibiting parents from making decisions for their family infringes on their rights.

⚙️ **Mr./Ms./Mx.** _____

President, Restaurant Association of Canada

You own two successful restaurants in Edmonton, and you have worked in restaurants since you were 17. You feel neutral about what families do in their own homes, but you think this bill would be a disaster if restaurant meals were included. You took time away from running your business to appear at committee because you think it is important that the bill be amended to exclude restaurant meals.

Character profiles



⚙️ **Mr./Ms./Mx.** _____

Restaurant Association of Canada

You were hired by the Association as a lobbyist. Your job is to try to get the government to pass laws that are good for the restaurant business. You do not like vegetables yourself, but your job is to argue that this bill has to change to protect restaurant owners.

⚙️ **Mr./Ms./Mx.** _____

Restaurant Association of Canada

You are a restaurateur with a chain of successful vegan restaurants. You joined the RAC four years ago because you wanted to promote opportunities for plant-based restaurants across Canada. You think this bill would be disastrous for vegan and vegetarian restaurateurs and hope to convince the committee this bill should not be passed into law.

Committee Chair

Chair of the Standing Committee on Food and Nutrition – Senate Affiliation A

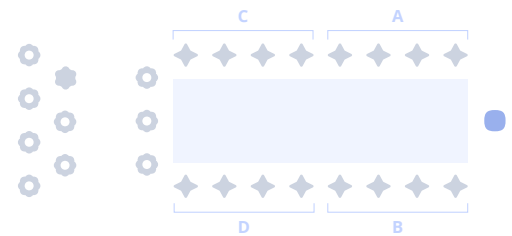


Name: _____

Role overview

The chair is a senator who is elected by their fellow committee members to run meetings and act as the committee spokesperson. The role of the chair is to guide the conversation, recognize who “has the floor” (whose turn it is to speak) and maintain order and decorum. In addition to calling meetings to order, it is usually the chair who adjourns committee meetings.

Senate committee chairs are entitled to participate in debate and vote like any other member of the committee, although they sometimes choose not to exercise the right to vote. The chair votes before other members.



Visual of role groups

Rules and decorum

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- Refer to senators as “Senator [their last name]”. Refer to witnesses as “Mr./Ms./Mx. [their last name].”



Committee Chair

Chair of the Standing Committee on Food and Nutrition – Senate Affiliation A



Name: _____

Committee preparation

Minds on: Reviewing the *Vegetable Harmony Act*

With your role and character in mind, look at the title, preamble, and clauses 4-10 of the ***Vegetable Harmony Act***. Beside each clause, consider your character's response to the clause with the following symbols:



Support



Oppose



Interesting /
notable



Unclear / want more
information

Breakout group 1: Arguments for and against the bill

In a small group, share arguments for and against the bill as it is currently written. Try to come up with as many arguments as you can on both sides – they don't necessarily need to be things you (or your character) agree with. Record the arguments in the chart provided.

As you discuss the bill, write down the arguments suggested by your group. The goal is for you to gain a broad understanding of different perspectives and how this bill could be received by Canadians before meeting with your role group, ensuring you consider multiple viewpoints as you prepare for the committee meeting.



Committee Chair

Chair of the Standing Committee on Food
and Nutrition – Senate Affiliation A



Name: _____



Committee Chair

Chair of the Standing Committee on Food and Nutrition – Senate Affiliation A



Name: _____

Breakout group 2: Goals and strategies

Work with your role group to develop a few common goals and strategies for the committee meeting, while keeping your character's individual position in mind.

Role specific guidelines

- **If you are a senator**, work with your Senate affiliation (A, B, C or D).
- **If you are a witness**, work with all the other witness groups, keeping in mind that you may be aligned on some issues, but not on others.
- If you are the **Cabinet minister** or **committee chair**, separately circulate between breakout groups to observe and record the varying goals of each group.

Goal

Example: Convince members this bill is in the best interest of parents.

Strategies to achieve the goal

Example:

- *Ask the minister an easy question, such as, "How will this bill benefit Canadian parents?" so they can highlight key talking points.*
- *Share a personal anecdote about how your parent agreeing you didn't have to eat broccoli anymore helped you feel more connected to them as a child.*

1 Goal

Strategies to achieve the goal



Name: _____

2 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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4 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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Committee Chair

Chair of the Standing Committee on Food and Nutrition – Senate Affiliation A



Name: _____

Chair script

Simulation instructions

As the chair, you will lead the meeting. Use the script below to organize what you will do and say at each stage of the committee meeting. Words in bold are your script.

I. Chair introductions

🕒 02 min

Good morning (or afternoon), senators, honourable minister, and honoured guests. Welcome to the Standing Committee on Food and Nutrition.

Today we will be studying an Act to regulate the serving of vegetables at dinner in Canadian households in the interests of family peace and harmony.

The Minister of Food will introduce this bill to our committee, and then we will hear speeches from:

- **The Canadian Vegetable Growers Association;**
- **The Council for the Rights of Families; and**
- **The Restaurant Association of Canada.**

We will then study and vote on each of the clauses in the bill and then have a final vote on whether or not to refer the bill back to the chamber.

Here are some rules for the meeting:

- a** Only senators on the committee are allowed to vote and to ask questions.
- b** If you would like to speak or ask a question, raise your hand. The Clerk will keep a list of people who would like to speak.
- c** You may only speak or ask a question during certain times in the meeting, and when I have called your name.



Name: _____

- d** Do not talk or whisper to each other during the meeting.
- e** Speak respectfully to each other. You will call me Mr./Madam/Mx. Chair. You will call senators and the minister by their title and name, for example “Senator Smith,” “Senator Bilodeau,” or “Minister Chan.” You will call the witnesses Mr./Ms./Mx. and their last name.

We will now hear from our very welcome guests. Thank you for taking the time to travel here today to share your opinions and expertise with us. When I call on you, please come and sit in the witness seats to make your presentation.

II. Cabinet minister presentation

🕒 05 min

Let’s begin with the Minister of Food. Minister, you have up to two minutes to speak followed by three minutes of questions.

Invite the minister to come up to the table to speak.

When the minister is finished, ask the committee members if they have any questions or comments for the minister:

Do any members of the committee have questions for the minister?

III. Witness presentations

🕒 20 min

After the minister has answered questions, invite them to move back to the gallery and call up all representatives from ONE of the following witness groups:

- Canadian Vegetable Growers Association
- Council for the Rights of Families
- Restaurant Association of Canada

Say:

We will now hear from _____,
_____ and _____
representing the _____

You have up to three minutes in total for your presentation followed by 4 minutes of questions.



Name:

At the end of the witnesses' presentations, say:

Do any members of the committee have questions for these witnesses?

Repeat for all witness groups.

IV. Clause-by-clause examination of the bill and amendments

🕒 20 min

You will now lead the committee through the clauses in the bill. All committee members (including you) will have a chance to talk about the specific words used in each clause, and then you will all vote on whether or not to approve each clause. You will skip the first three clauses that are simply about the title and definitions and begin at clause 4.

You will introduce this part of the meeting by reading the following script:

We will now begin our clause-by-clause examination of the bill, starting with clause 4.

For each clause, I will ask if there is any discussion. If you want to suggest an amendment, that is the time to introduce it. You introduce an amendment by saying "I propose that we amend this clause." You will then explain the amendment and hand a written copy of it to the Clerk. If you introduce an amendment, we will discuss and vote on it first. If the amendment passes, the Clerk will change the wording of the clause. If it does not, the wording will remain the same.

We will vote on each clause by raising hands. I will say, "If you want this clause to pass, please raise your hands," and then, "If you want to defeat this clause, please raise your hands."

The Clerk will count the votes. If more of us vote for the clause to pass, it will stay in the bill. If more of us vote to defeat it, the Clerk will remove it from the bill.

V. Vote to report the bill

🕒 03 min

The final vote on the bill is whether or not to report the bill back to the chamber. That means the committee is finished with the bill, and it is time to move it on to the next step.

Members of the committee, is it agreed that I report this bill to the Senate?

VI. Conclusion

Thank everyone for their time and effort and say that the meeting is adjourned.



★ Senators

Senate Affiliation A

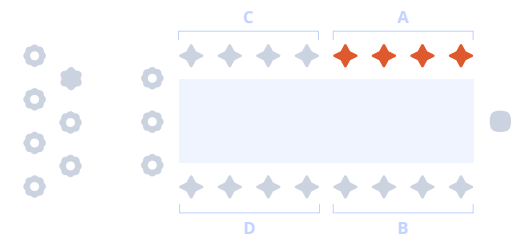


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Role overview

The Senate is an important part of Canada's system of government. Senators are appointed by the Governor General to represent their home province or territory. Senators introduce, debate, study and vote on bills. They also investigate issues facing Canadians and advocate for people from across Canada.

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Visual of role groups

Rules and decorum

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★ Senators

Senate Affiliation A



Name: _____

Committee preparation

Minds on: Reviewing the *Vegetable Harmony Act*

With your role and character in mind, look at the title, preamble, and clauses 4-10 of the ***Vegetable Harmony Act***. Beside each clause, consider your character's response to the clause with the following symbols:



Support



Oppose



**Interesting /
notable**



**Unclear / want more
information**

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★ Senators

Senate Affiliation A



Name: _____



★ Senators

Senate Affiliation A



Name: _____

Breakout group 2: Goals and strategies

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Example: Convince members this bill is in the best interest of parents.

Strategies to achieve the goal

Example:

- *Ask the minister an easy question, such as, "How will this bill benefit Canadian parents?" so they can highlight key talking points.*
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Strategies to achieve the goal



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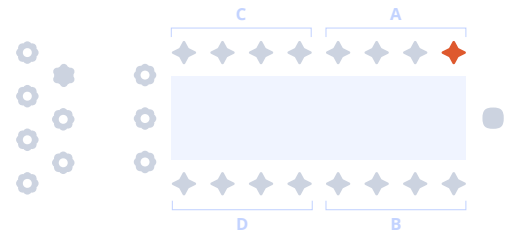
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Visual of role groups

Amendment

During the simulation, you will propose an amendment to the ***Vegetable Harmony Act*** to include two additional vegetables on the prohibited list. You will present your amendment during the clause-by-clause examination of the bill. After the chair asks whether there is any discussion about clause 5, which lists the prohibited vegetables, you will say:

That this bill, in Clause 5, be amended by replacing paragraph (f) on page 4 by the following:

(f) asparagus;

(g) beets; and

(h) Such other vegetables as may be added by regulation from time to time.

Name:

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★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment – Senate Affiliation A



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★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment – Senate Affiliation A



Name: _____



★ Senators

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Senate Affiliation B

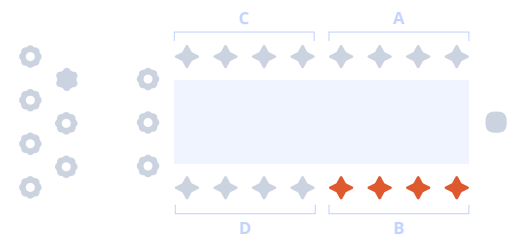


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Senate Affiliation B



Name: _____



★ Senators

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Name: _____

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★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment – Senate Affiliation B

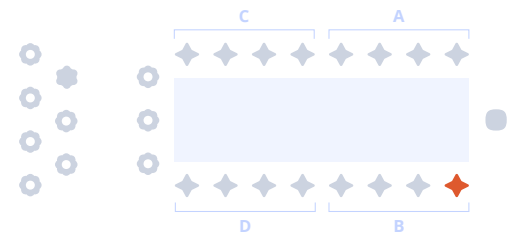


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In committees, senators closely examine bills, hear testimony from experts and people who may be affected by potential laws. They may recommend changes, known as amendments, based on this research and study.



Visual of role groups

Amendment

During the simulation, you will propose an amendment to the ***Vegetable Harmony Act*** to ensure parents have to serve their children dessert with dinner. You will present your amendment during the clause-by-clause examination of the bill. After the chair asks whether there is any discussion about Clause 5, which lists prohibited vegetables, you will say:

That this bill be amended by adding after Clause 5 on page 4 the following:

5.1 No parent shall serve a dinner which does not include a dessert.

Rules and decorum

There are several rules committee participants must follow:

- Be polite and respectful.
- When a senator wishes to speak, they must raise their hand and wait silently to be called on by the chair.
- Senators must wait until they have been called on by the chair before they may speak.
- Do not disrupt the meeting by talking or whispering during the meeting.
- Witnesses and the minister sit in the gallery until invited by the chair to sit at the committee table.
- Only committee members are permitted to participate in the debate or to vote.
- Refer to senators as “Senator [their last name]”. Refer to witnesses as “Mr./Ms./Mx. [their last name].”



★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment – Senate Affiliation B



Name: _____

Committee preparation

Minds on: Reviewing the *Vegetable Harmony Act*

With your role and character in mind, look at the title, preamble, and clauses 4-10 of the ***Vegetable Harmony Act***. Beside each clause, consider your character's response to the clause with the following symbols:



Support



Oppose



Interesting /
notable



Unclear / want more
information

Breakout group 1: Arguments for and against the bill

In a small group, share arguments for and against the bill as it is currently written. Try to come up with as many arguments as you can on both sides – they don't necessarily need to be things you (or your character) agree with. Record the arguments in the chart provided.

As you discuss the bill, write down the arguments suggested by your group. The goal is for you to gain a broad understanding of different perspectives and how this bill could be received by Canadians before meeting with your role group, ensuring you consider multiple viewpoints as you prepare for the committee meeting.



★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment – Senate Affiliation B



Name: _____



★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment – Senate Affiliation B



Name: _____

Breakout group 2: Goals and strategies

Work with your role group to develop a few common goals and strategies for the committee meeting, while keeping your character's individual position in mind.

Role specific guidelines

- **If you are a senator**, work with your Senate affiliation (A, B, C or D).
- **If you are a witness**, work with all the other witness groups, keeping in mind that you may be aligned on some issues, but not on others.
- If you are the **Cabinet minister** or **committee chair**, separately circulate between breakout groups to observe and record the varying goals of each group.

Goal

Example: Convince members this bill is in the best interest of parents.

Strategies to achieve the goal

Example:

- *Ask the minister an easy question, such as, "How will this bill benefit Canadian parents?" so they can highlight key talking points.*
- *Share a personal anecdote about how your parent agreeing you didn't have to eat broccoli anymore helped you feel more connected to them as a child.*

1 Goal

Strategies to achieve the goal



Name: _____

2 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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3 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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4 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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★ Senators

Senate Affiliation C

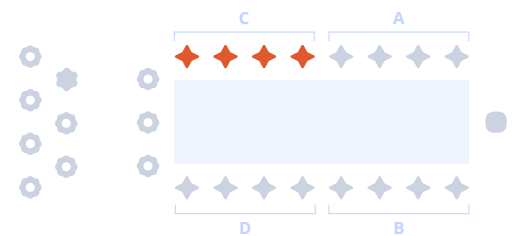


Name: _____

Role overview

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In committees, senators closely examine bills, hear testimony from experts and people who may be affected by potential laws. They may recommend changes, known as amendments, based on this research and study.



Visual of role groups

Rules and decorum

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★ Senators

Senate Affiliation C



Name: _____

Committee preparation

Minds on: Reviewing the *Vegetable Harmony Act*

With your role and character in mind, look at the title, preamble, and clauses 4-10 of the ***Vegetable Harmony Act***. Beside each clause, consider your character's response to the clause with the following symbols:



Support



Oppose



**Interesting /
notable**



**Unclear / want more
information**

Breakout group 1: Arguments for and against the bill

In a small group, share arguments for and against the bill as it is currently written. Try to come up with as many arguments as you can on both sides – they don't necessarily need to be things you (or your character) agree with. Record the arguments in the chart provided.

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★ Senators

Senate Affiliation C



Name: _____



★ Senators

Senate Affiliation C



Name: _____

Breakout group 2: Goals and strategies

Work with your role group to develop a few common goals and strategies for the committee meeting, while keeping your character's individual position in mind.

Role specific guidelines

- **If you are a senator**, work with your Senate affiliation (A, B, C or D).
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Goal

Example: Convince members this bill is in the best interest of parents.

Strategies to achieve the goal

Example:

- *Ask the minister an easy question, such as, "How will this bill benefit Canadian parents?" so they can highlight key talking points.*
- *Share a personal anecdote about how your parent agreeing you didn't have to eat broccoli anymore helped you feel more connected to them as a child.*

1 Goal

Strategies to achieve the goal



Name: _____

2 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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4 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment – Senate Affiliation C

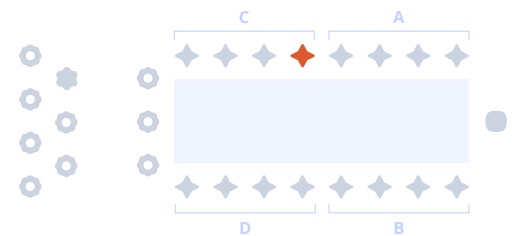


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In committees, senators closely examine bills, hear testimony from experts and people who may be affected by potential laws. They may recommend changes, known as amendments, based on this research and study.



Visual of role groups

Amendment

During the simulation, you will propose an amendment to the ***Vegetable Harmony Act*** to reduce the fines associated with breaking the law. You will present your amendment during the clause-by-clause examination of the bill. After the chair asks whether there is any discussion about Clause 7, which lists offences, you will say:

That this bill be amended by replacing paragraphs (a) and (b) on page 4 by the following:

(a) for a first offence, to a fine not exceeding \$1000; and

(b) for a subsequent offence, to a fine not exceeding \$10,000.



Name:

Rules and decorum

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★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment –
Senate Affiliation C



Name: _____

Committee Preparation

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With your role and character in mind, look at the title, preamble, and clauses 4-10 of the ***Vegetable Harmony Act***. Beside each clause, consider your character's response to the clause with the following symbols:



Support



Oppose



Interesting /
notable



Unclear / want more
information

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★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment –
Senate Affiliation C



Name: _____



★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment – Senate Affiliation C



Name: _____

Breakout group 2: Goals and strategies

Work with your role group to develop a few common goals and strategies for the committee meeting, while keeping your character's individual position in mind.

Role specific guidelines

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Goal

Example: Convince members this bill is in the best interest of parents.

Strategies to achieve the goal

Example:

- *Ask the minister an easy question, such as, "How will this bill benefit Canadian parents?" so they can highlight key talking points.*
- *Share a personal anecdote about how your parent agreeing you didn't have to eat broccoli anymore helped you feel more connected to them as a child.*

1 Goal

Strategies to achieve the goal



Name: _____

2 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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3 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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4 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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★ Senators

Senate Affiliation D

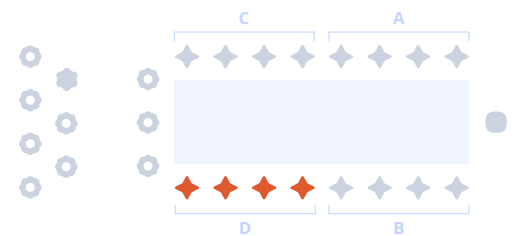


Name: _____

Role overview

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In committees, senators closely examine bills, hear testimony from experts and people who may be affected by potential laws. They may recommend changes, known as amendments, based on this research and study.



Visual of role groups

Rules and decorum

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- Refer to senators as "Senator [their last name]". Refer to witnesses as "Mr./Ms./Mx. [their last name]."



★ Senators

Senate Affiliation D



Name: _____

Committee preparation

Minds on: Reviewing the *Vegetable Harmony Act*

With your role and character in mind, look at the title, preamble, and clauses 4-10 of the ***Vegetable Harmony Act***. Beside each clause, consider your character's response to the clause with the following symbols:



Support



Oppose



**Interesting /
notable**



**Unclear / want more
information**

Breakout group 1: Arguments for and against the bill

In a small group, share arguments for and against the bill as it is currently written. Try to come up with as many arguments as you can on both sides – they don't necessarily need to be things you (or your character) agree with. Record the arguments in the chart provided.

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★ Senators

Senate Affiliation D



Name: _____



★ Senators

Senate Affiliation D



Name: _____

Breakout group 2: Goals and strategies

Work with your role group to develop a few common goals and strategies for the committee meeting, while keeping your character's individual position in mind.

Role specific guidelines

- **If you are a senator**, work with your Senate affiliation (A, B, C or D).
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- If you are the **Cabinet minister** or **committee chair**, separately circulate between breakout groups to observe and record the varying goals of each group.

Goal

Example: Convince members this bill is in the best interest of parents.

Strategies to achieve the goal

Example:

- *Ask the minister an easy question, such as, "How will this bill benefit Canadian parents?" so they can highlight key talking points.*
- *Share a personal anecdote about how your parent agreeing you didn't have to eat broccoli anymore helped you feel more connected to them as a child.*

1 Goal

Strategies to achieve the goal



Name: _____

2 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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3 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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4 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment – Senate Affiliation D

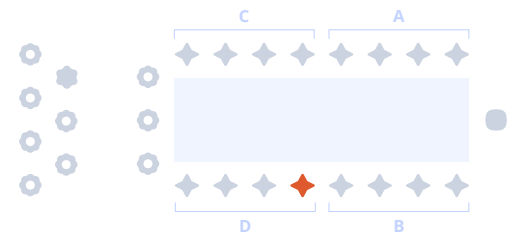


Name: _____

Role overview

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In committees, senators closely examine bills, hear testimony from experts and people who may be affected by potential laws. They may recommend changes, known as amendments, based on this research and study.



Visual of role groups

Amendment

During the simulation, you will propose an amendment to the ***Vegetable Harmony Act*** to exclude restaurants from the bill. You will present your amendment during the clause-by-clause examination of the bill. After the chair asks whether there is any discussion about Clause 12, which discusses regulations, you will say:

That this bill be amended by adding after Clause 12 on page 6 the following:

12.1 For greater clarity, this Act does not apply to meals served at restaurants.

Rules and decorum

There are several rules committee participants must follow:

- Be polite and respectful.
- When a senator wishes to speak, they must raise their hand and wait silently to be called on by the chair.
- Senators must wait until they have been called on by the chair before they may speak.
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★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment – Senate Affiliation D



Name: _____

Committee preparation

Minds on: Reviewing the *Vegetable Harmony Act*

With your role and character in mind, look at the title, preamble, and clauses 4-10 of the ***Vegetable Harmony Act***. Beside each clause, consider your character's response to the clause with the following symbols:



Support



Oppose



Interesting /
notable



Unclear / want more
information

Breakout group 1: Arguments for and against the bill

In a small group, share arguments for and against the bill as it is currently written. Try to come up with as many arguments as you can on both sides – they don't necessarily need to be things you (or your character) agree with. Record the arguments in the chart provided.

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★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment – Senate Affiliation D



Name: _____



★ Senators

Senator presenting an amendment – Senate Affiliation D



Name: _____

Breakout group 2: Goals and strategies

Work with your role group to develop a few common goals and strategies for the committee meeting, while keeping your character's individual position in mind.

Role specific guidelines

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Goal

Example: Convince members this bill is in the best interest of parents.

Strategies to achieve the goal

Example:

- *Ask the minister an easy question, such as, "How will this bill benefit Canadian parents?" so they can highlight key talking points.*
- *Share a personal anecdote about how your parent agreeing you didn't have to eat broccoli anymore helped you feel more connected to them as a child.*

1 Goal

Strategies to achieve the goal



Name: _____

2 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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3 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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4 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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Minister of Food

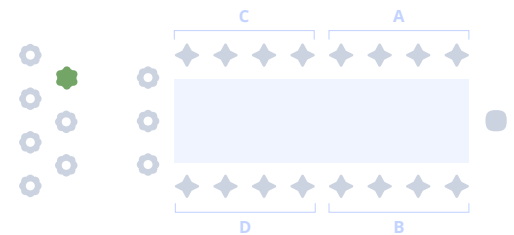


Name: _____

Role overview

Cabinet ministers are members of the governing party who are selected by the prime minister to offer advice and, usually, to lead a government department.

As part of their responsibilities, ministers introduce bills related to their departments. When bills make it to the committee stage of the legislative process, Cabinet ministers will often attend committee meetings to present the bill and answer questions from committee members.



Visual of role groups

Rules and decorum

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Name:

Additional context

As the Minister of Food, you oversee the government department responsible for issues related to growing, manufacturing and inspecting food in Canada. You will present the Vegetable Harmony Act to the committee. Use the information below to organize what you will say during your presentation and how you will answer questions from senators.

Your position on this bill

This bill was your idea, and the prime minister and other members of Cabinet support it. You think it will be helpful for Canadian families. You are open to the committee making amendments that would make the bill even better than it is now.

Possible arguments

- Children are usually more sensitive to new tastes or textures than adults are. While some children are not fussy eaters, those who are more sensitive will find certain foods hard to eat.
- As long as children are offered fruit and other vegetables, they will get enough nutrition to be healthy. They don't need to eat the vegetables they hate.
- This bill will lead to much more harmony in a family's day-to-day life. Removing dinnertime arguments about food will be good for families.
- Food should be celebrated and enjoyed. Children will develop a healthier relationship with food if they are not forced to eat things they don't enjoy.
- Perhaps if children are never exposed to vegetables they don't like, they will have a positive attitude about eating vegetables and will eat more of them as adults.

These arguments are only suggestions. You can also develop your own as you prepare for the committee meeting.





Name: _____

Committee preparation

Minds on: Reviewing the *Vegetable Harmony Act*

With your role and character in mind, look at the title, preamble, and clauses 4-10 of the ***Vegetable Harmony Act***. Beside each clause, consider your character's response to the clause with the following symbols:



Support



Oppose



**Interesting /
notable**



**Unclear / want more
information**

Breakout group 1: Arguments for and against the bill

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Name:



Minister of Food



Name: _____

Breakout group 2: Goals and strategies

Work with your role group to develop a few common goals and strategies for the committee meeting, while keeping your character's individual position in mind.

Role specific guidelines

- **If you are a senator**, work with your Senate affiliation (A, B, C or D).
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Goal

Example: Convince members this bill is in the best interest of parents.

Strategies to achieve the goal

Example:

- *Ask the minister an easy question, such as, "How will this bill benefit Canadian parents?" so they can highlight key talking points.*
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1 Goal

Strategies to achieve the goal



Name: _____

2 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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3 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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4 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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Witnesses

Canadian Vegetable Growers Association

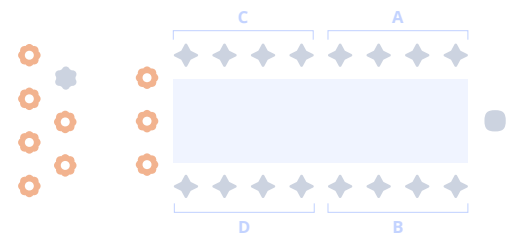


Name: _____

Role overview

Parliamentary committees invite members of the public, subject matter experts and representatives of organizations to answer questions or present information in committee meetings. These are called witnesses. Witnesses express their points of view on bills, share their experience and expertise and provide context that senators can consider when refining the bill.

During committee meetings, witnesses are often asked to deliver a presentation expressing their opinion on the bill. Then committee members ask questions and comment on the information the witnesses have presented.



Visual of role groups

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Name:

Additional context

As a committee witness, your job is to make sure parliamentarians understand the opinions, views, needs and goals of the people you represent. Use the information below to organize what you will say during the presentation and how you will answer questions from senators.

What is the Canadian Vegetable Growers Association (CVGA)?

The CVGA represents farmers who grow vegetables in Canada. There are thousands of farmers who belong to this organization. Some of them have very large farms that grow huge crops of vegetables for grocery stores and large companies. Some of them are small farmers who sell their food in local stores and farmers' markets. Farmers pay an annual membership to the CVGA so that the CVGA will speak on their behalf and will promote vegetable eating in Canada.

What is your organization's position on the bill?

The CVGA opposes this bill, as it would affect many members' livelihood and ability to stay in business. You are also concerned about its effect on the health of young Canadians and the broader Canadian economy.

Possible arguments

- Vegetables are an important part of a healthy diet. The Canada Food Guide recommends that children and teens eat plenty of fruits and vegetables each day.
- This bill will hurt vegetable farmers across the country. Farming is a backbone of the Canadian economy, and thousands of farms may go out of business if this bill is passed. This could weaken the entire economy, including our trade relationships with other countries.
- If vegetable farms close, a variety of fresh vegetables will become harder to find and will likely become more expensive. Canadians seeking these vegetables may have to buy from international growers, weakening the drive support local producers.

These arguments are only suggestions. You can also develop your own as you prepare for the committee meeting.

Possible goals and strategies for committee

- Try to convince senators of the negative impact of this bill on your association members, and the potential effect on the broader economy.
- Remind the committee that there are other ways to promote family harmony and healthy eating, while still supporting Canadian farmers. Suggest that parents ask children what vegetables they like to eat and promote consumption of those vegetables as part of their healthy daily diet.





Name: _____

Committee preparation

Minds on: Reviewing the *Vegetable Harmony Act*

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Support



Oppose



**Interesting /
notable**



**Unclear / want more
information**

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Witnesses

Canadian Vegetable Growers Association



Name: _____



Witnesses

Canadian Vegetable Growers Association



Name: _____

Breakout group 2: Goals and strategies

Work with your role group to develop a few common goals and strategies for the committee meeting, while keeping your character's individual position in mind.

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Goal

Example: Convince members this bill is in the best interest of parents.

Strategies to achieve the goal

Example:

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1 Goal

Strategies to achieve the goal



Name: _____

2 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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3 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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4 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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Witnesses

Council for the Rights of Families

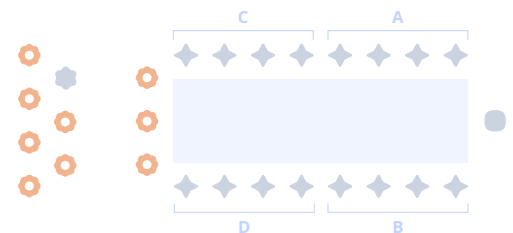


Name: _____

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Visual of role groups

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- Refer to senators as “Senator [their last name]”. Refer to witnesses as “Mr./Ms./Mx. [their last name].”



Name:

Additional context

As a committee witness, your job is to make sure parliamentarians understand the opinions, views, needs and goals of the people you represent. Use the information below to organize what you will say during the presentation and how you will answer questions from senators.

What is the Council for the Rights of Families (CRF)?

The CRF is a group of Canadian parents, caregivers and youth representatives from across the country. The CRF believes that families should have the right to make their own decisions about their lives, without excessive regulation from governments or other organizations. They encourage the government to pass laws that expand their rights.

What is your organization's position on the bill?

The CRF believes that families, not government, should decide what vegetables should be served during meals. The CRF is against this bill.

Possible arguments

- Families should have the right to operate their household the way they think is best. Governments should only pass laws about parenting when the laws protect the health and safety of children. This bill does nothing to protect the health and safety of children.
- Vegetables are healthy for everyone. Responsible parents and caregivers serve a variety of vegetables to their children so they get all the healthy vitamins and minerals that they need.
- Some children enjoy eating vegetables. In some cuisines, these vegetables are commonly consumed from a young age. This bill discriminates against these cuisines.
- The process in the bill that would allow children to eat vegetables is too difficult. Many families will break the rules because of this and will risk getting into trouble. The penalties in the bill are much too high and would hurt families.

These arguments are only suggestions. You can also develop your own as you prepare for the committee meeting.

Possible goals and strategies for committee

- Encourage the committee not to pass a bill that infringes on a family's right to choose what they serve in their own households.





Name: _____

Committee preparation

Minds on: Reviewing the *Vegetable Harmony Act*

With your role and character in mind, look at the title, preamble, and clauses 4-10 of the ***Vegetable Harmony Act***. Beside each clause, consider your character's response to the clause with the following symbols:



Support



Oppose



**Interesting /
notable**



**Unclear / want more
information**

Breakout group 1: Arguments for and against the bill

In a small group, share arguments for and against the bill as it is currently written. Try to come up with as many arguments as you can on both sides – they don't necessarily need to be things you (or your character) agree with. Record the arguments in the chart provided.

As you discuss the bill, write down the arguments suggested by your group. The goal is for you to gain a broad understanding of different perspectives and how this bill could be received by Canadians before meeting with your role group, ensuring you consider multiple viewpoints as you prepare for the committee meeting.





Council for the Rights of Families



Witnesses

Council for the Rights of Families



Name: _____

Breakout group 2: Goals and strategies

Work with your role group to develop a few common goals and strategies for the committee meeting, while keeping your character's individual position in mind.

Role specific guidelines

- **If you are a senator**, work with your Senate affiliation (A, B, C or D).
- **If you are a witness**, work with all the other witness groups, keeping in mind that you may be aligned on some issues, but not on others.
- If you are the **Cabinet minister** or **committee chair**, separately circulate between breakout groups to observe and record the varying goals of each group.

Goal

Example: Convince members this bill is in the best interest of parents.

Strategies to achieve the goal

Example:

- *Ask the minister an easy question, such as, "How will this bill benefit Canadian parents?" so they can highlight key talking points.*
- *Share a personal anecdote about how your parent agreeing you didn't have to eat broccoli anymore helped you feel more connected to them as a child.*

1 Goal

Strategies to achieve the goal



Name: _____

2 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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3 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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4 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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Witnesses

Restaurant Association of Canada

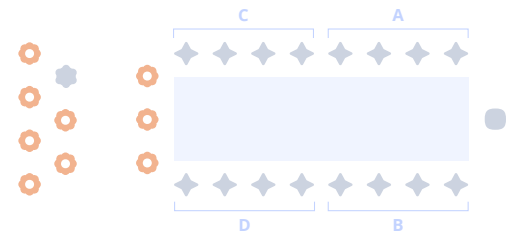


Name: _____

Role overview

Parliamentary committees invite members of the public, subject matter experts and representatives of organizations to answer questions or present information in committee meetings. These are called witnesses. Witnesses express their points of view on bills, share their experience and expertise and provide context that senators can consider when refining the bill.

During committee meetings, witnesses are often asked to deliver a presentation expressing their opinion on the bill. Then committee members ask questions and comment on the information the witnesses have presented.



Visual of role groups

Rules and decorum

There are several rules committee participants must follow:

- Be polite and respectful.
- When a senator wishes to speak, they must raise their hand and wait silently to be called on by the chair.
- Senators must wait until they have been called on by the chair before they may speak.
- Do not disrupt the meeting by talking or whispering during the meeting.
- Witnesses and the minister sit in the gallery until invited by the chair to sit at the committee table.
- Only committee members are permitted to participate in the debate or to vote.
- Refer to senators as “Senator [their last name]”. Refer to witnesses as “Mr./Ms./Mx. [their last name].”



Name:

Additional context

As a committee witness, your job is to make sure parliamentarians understand the opinions, views, needs and goals of the people you represent. Use the information below to organize what you will say during the presentation and how you will answer questions from senators.

What is the Restaurant Association of Canada (RAC)?

The RAC is an organization for people who own and manage restaurants and other eateries all over Canada. The RAC makes presentations to the federal and provincial governments to let them know what restaurant owners think about new laws that impact the restaurant industry in Canada.

What is your organization's position on the bill?

You are worried about how the bill will impact restaurant owners if the new law applies to restaurant meals. It would impact ordering models, menus, pricing and revenues for your association members. The RAC is neutral on what people do in their own homes but would like the committee to amend the bill so that restaurant meals are not included.

Possible arguments

- This bill will have a major impact on restaurant operations and affect revenues across the country.
- Vegetarian and vegan restaurants would be particularly affected by the bill. It is not fair to expect them to fundamentally change their menus to eliminate all these vegetables.
- Restaurants are an important part of the Canadian economy, generating billions of dollars each year. Losing even a relatively small part of that revenue would affect the whole country.
- If parents break the law by feeding their children restricted vegetables in a restaurant, the RAC is worried that the restaurant owner or manager could also receive a fine, further worsening the financial impact on restaurant owners.

These arguments are only suggestions. You can also develop your own as you prepare for the committee meeting.

Possible goals and strategies for committee

- Encourage the committee to amend the bill so that restaurant meals are excluded.





Name: _____

Committee preparation

Minds on: Reviewing the *Vegetable Harmony Act*

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Witnesses

Restaurant Association of Canada



Name:



Witnesses

Restaurant Association of Canada



Name: _____

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1 Goal

Strategies to achieve the goal



Name: _____

2 Goal	Strategies to achieve the goal
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